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Experiment 8: Case Study on the Business Impact of a No-Code Application Implementation

1. Aim

To study how the implementation of a no-code application changes the operations, cost and productivity of an organisation. The scenario below is an illustrative case built for academic analysis; the figures are not from a real organisation and should be replaced with real data if available.

2. Background

A mid-sized training institute managed student enquiries, admissions, fee receipts and placement records using separate spreadsheets and paper files. Staff spent long hours on repetitive data entry, follow-ups were missed, duplicate records appeared in the admissions list, and management reports took several days to compile. Leadership wanted a faster and more reliable system without the delay and cost of a custom software project.

3. Implementation

- A no-code platform was selected after comparing three options on cost, ease of use and integration with the institute's email system.
- An admissions form, an enquiry tracker, a fee collection register and a monthly dashboard were built by two trained staff members in about four weeks.
- Validation rules were added to prevent duplicate phone numbers and missing mandatory fields.
- An approval workflow routed fee waivers to the director, and automatic email reminders were sent for pending follow-ups.
- Staff were trained over two weeks, and the old spreadsheets were migrated into the new application after cleaning.

4. Business Impact (Illustrative)

Parameter	Before	After	Change
Time to prepare the monthly report	3 days	Under 1 hour	Large reduction
Missed follow-ups per month	About 40	About 5	Substantial reduction
Duplicate admission records	Frequent	Prevented by validation	Improved data quality
Fee receipt turnaround	Next working day	Same day	Faster service
Software cost	Not applicable	Subscription and staff time only	No custom development cost

5. Analysis

The main gains came from process redesign rather than from the technology alone. Validation rules removed duplicate entries, the workflow made responsibilities clear, and dashboards gave management timely information. The no-code tool made it possible for the administrative team to adjust forms themselves, which reduced the waiting time for changes that previously required a developer.

Several risks were identified during the project. Some staff were used to paper files and were reluctant to change, which was managed through training and by keeping the first version of the form close to the old format. The institute also depended on a single vendor, which was reduced by exporting the data regularly to a spreadsheet and documenting the application structure.

6. Cost and Benefit Considerations

Subscription fees and the staff time spent on building the application were compared with the time saved on routine tasks. In an organisation of this size, the payback period depends mostly on the number of staff hours recovered each month. A simple measure is to multiply the hours saved by the hourly cost of the staff involved and compare the result with the annual subscription cost.

7. Limitations

Because the scenario is illustrative, the quantitative figures cannot be used as evidence about any real organisation. The study also does not measure the effect on student satisfaction, which would require a survey before and after the change.

8. Result and Conclusion

The no-code implementation improved speed, accuracy and visibility while keeping costs low. The business value depends on combining the tool with clear process ownership, training and change management. Technology alone does not produce the benefit; the redesign of the process around it does.